

Dr. Kayla W. T. Kolff

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- 2025 – pres. **Postdoctoral researcher**
Institute for Cognitive Science, Osnabrück University, Germany
- 2025 – pres. **Communications officer and EDI committee member**
European Federation for Primatology
- 2024 – 2025 **Research Fellow**
Ruhr University Bochum, Germany
- 2024 **Project Intern**
Great Ape Survival Partnership, United Nations of Environmental Programme, Kenya
- 2020 – 2025 **PhD candidate**
Institute for Cognitive Science, Osnabrück University, Germany
- 2019 – 2020 **Guest Researcher and Research Assistant**
Tai Chimpanzee Project and Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Germany

EDUCATION

- 2025 **Ph.D. in Cognitive Science**, Osnabrück University, Germany
- 2019 **M.Sc. Environmental Biology**, Utrecht University, The Netherlands
- 2017 **B.Sc. Liberal Arts and Sciences**, Maastricht University, The Netherlands
- 2014 **International Baccalaureate (IB)**, Braeburn Garden Estate, Kenya

PUBLICATIONS

- Kolff, K.**, Acosta Flórez, D., Mascaro, A., & Pika, S. (2025). Insect applications to open wounds by chimpanzees in the wild: first insights from East African chimpanzees. *Scientific Reports*, 15(1), 31242.
- Kolff, K.**, & Pika, S. (2025). Turn-taking in grooming interactions of chimpanzees (*Pan troglodytes schweinfurthii*) in the wild: the role of demographic and social factors. *Animal Cognition*, 28(1), 26.
- Ozaki, Y., Tierney, A., Pfordresher, P. Q., McBride, J. M., Benetos, E., ... **Kolff, K.**, ... & Savage, P. E. (2024). Globally, songs and instrumental melodies are slower and higher and use more stable pitches than speech: A Registered Report. *Science advances*, 10(20), eadm9797.
- Webb, C. E., **Kolff, K.**, Du, X., & de Waal, F. (2020). Jealous Behavior in Chimpanzees Elicited by Social Intruders. *Affective Science*, 1(4), 199-207. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s42761-020-00019-5>
- Goldsborough, Z., van Leeuwen, E. J. C., **Kolff, K. W. T.**, de Waal, F B. M., & Webb, C. E. (2019). Do

van Boekholt, B., **Kolff, K.**^{*}, Vlaeyen, J. M., Abreu, F., Southern, L. M., Tibesar, P., & Pika, S. (in press). Turn-taking beyond humans: Insights from nonhuman animals. In International encyclopedia of language and linguistics. Elsevier.

Kolff, K., & Pika, S. (under review, iScience). When grooming stalls: Assessing communicative repair, negotiation and progressivity.

Kolff, K., & Pika, S. (under review, iScience). Interactional infrastructure: The organisation of turn-taking during grooming interactions of chimpanzees in the wild.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Interactional success: The role of repair mechanisms in coordinating grooming interactions of chimpanzees (2026). Talk presented at 11th European Federation for Primatology Meeting, Montpellier, France.

Communicative repair in grooming interactions of wild-living chimpanzees (2025). Talk presented in symposium “*The rise and fall of the chimpanzee community at Ngogo, Uganda*” (organised by Dr. A. Sandel, Dr. R. Reddy, Dr. J. Negrey and Dr. D. Watts) at the American Association of Biological Anthropologists, Denver, North America.

Unearthing the roots of medicinal behaviour and cognition in Pan species (2024). Talk presented in symposium “*Medical cognition in non-human primates: Prospects and challenges*” (organised by Prof. S. Pika and Dr. T. Deschner) at the 10th European Federation of Primatology, Lausanne, Zurich.

Insights into communicative repair in non-human primates: The case of chimpanzee grooming (2023). Talk presented in symposium “*Communicative repair: What is it, how did it evolve, and how can it be studied across species?*” (organised by Dr. R. Heesen and D. M. Fröhlich), at the Protolang 8 Conference Series, Rome, Italy.

Interactional success: The role of repair mechanisms in coordinating grooming interactions of chimpanzees (2023). Talk presented in symposium “*Coordinated interactions across nonhuman primates*” (organised by K.Kolff, Dr. F. Abreu and B. van Boekholt) at the 29th International Primatological Society Congress, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia.

Communicative repair in nonhuman primates: the role of multimodality. Poster presented at the 1st International MultiModal Communication Symposium, Barcelona, Spain.

The Evolutionary Roots of Human Communicative Repair: The Case of Chimpanzee Grooming (2022). Flash talk and poster presented at the Proceedings of Joint Conference on Language Evolution, Kanazawa, Japan.

AWARDS AND GRANTS

2026	Seed Funding Osnabrück University
2026	Conference travel grant from DAAD
2024	Conference travel grant from Gesellschaft für Primatologie and European Federation of Primatology
2023	Conference travel grant from Gesellschaft für Primatologie
2021 - 2023	Doctoral fellowship - Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft (DFG) Research Training Group Situated Cognition

*Joint first co-authored